

CHEYENNE A. BLACK

<https://cheyenne-black.github.io/>

◇ cheyenne.a.black@gmail.com ◇ cheyenne-black@ucsd.edu

Washington, DC 20036

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Political Science, The University of Oklahoma May 2026

Concentrations: Public Policy, Research Methodology, American Government

Dissertation: *Rethinking Space Policy: From Outer Space to Inner Dynamics Using Discourse Network Analysis, Topic Modeling, and Policy Actor Affiliations*

Chair: Joseph Ripberger, Committee: Deven Carlson, Charles Finocchiaro, Mark Raymond, Shad Satterthwaite

M.A., Political Science, University of Oklahoma May 2022

Concentrations: Public Policy and Research Methodology

B.S., Political Science, Appalachian State University

Concentration: Legal Studies May 2019

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Space Policy, Science & Technology Policy, Environmental Policy, Research Methods

Secondary: Policy Process, Computational Social Science, Public-Private Partnerships, Coalition Dynamics

PUBLICATIONS

Zoey Rosen, Abby Bitterman, Makenzie Krocak, Joseph Ripberger, Sarah Melcher, Vanessa Dunham, **Cheyenne Black**, and Angela Person (2026). "A Comprehensive Inventory and Review of Color in Meteorological Graphics." *Forthcoming in the Journal of Operational Meteorology*

Cheyenne Black (2025). "Astro-nots Bezos, Branson, and Musk compared to NASA: promises and pitfalls of using sentiment analysis to assess differences between commercial and government space missions."

Quality and Quantity: doi.org/10.1007/s11135-025-02213-8

Kaitlin Peach, Andrew Fox, Kuhika Gupta, Joseph Ripberger, **Cheyenne Black**, Tristan Winkle, and Hank Jenkins-Smith (2025). "American Public Opinion on US Responses to Russia's Nuclear Threats in Ukraine."

Global Policy: doi.org/10.1111/1758-5899.13490

Miguel Jimenez, Ali Khalighifar, Carolyn Burt, **Cheyenne Black**, Maggie Leon-Corwin, Andrew Fox, Hank Jenkins-Smith, Carol Silva, Grace Trankina, Jeffrey Kelly, Kyle Horton (2025). "Integrating Multi-Scale Terrestrial and Atmospheric Predictors Enhances Nocturnal Bird Migration Forecasts."

Ornithological Applications: doi.org/10.1093/ornithapp/duaf001

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Scholar Sep. 2026 – current

The UC Institute on Global Conflict and Cooperation

Supervisor: Neil Narang

- Contributed to a research network comprised of scholars from across the University of California and the Los Alamos and Lawrence Livermore National Laboratories.
- Conducted research projects focused on space policy, public-private partnerships, institutional change, and defense governance.

Summer Associate/Adjunct Associate May 2025 – Dec. 2025

The RAND Corporation

Supervisor(s): Eder Sousa; Bonnie Triezenberg

- Evaluated USAF fighter jet capability evolution to inform a modernization framework for USSF legacy space systems. Conducted within RAND's Defense and Political Sciences Department, Santa Monica, CA.

Graduate Research Assistant

Jun. 2022 – May 2025

The Institute for Public Policy Research and Analysis

Supervisor(s): Joseph Ripberger; Hank Jenkins-Smith

- Assisted in research projects on policy topics including, but not limited to, national security, the environment, artificial lights at night, weather risk communication, and nuclear arsenal retention.
- Provided support in creating frequency reports, preparing presentation materials, collaborating on research projects, and authoring academic materials.

Graduate Student Assistant

Sep. 2023 – Sep. 2024

U.S. Department of State - Office of Policy, Planning, and Resources, VSFS

Supervisor: Thomas Wonder

- Assisted in gathering information and analyzing global public opinion topics and information through the Research and Evaluation Unit.
- Worked on projects concerning environmental policy in Europe, attitudes and behaviors of disinformation, security cooperation, and views on trade and foreign investment.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

Aug. 2024 – May 2026

University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science

- Developed and delivered university-level courses *Making Public Policy (PSC 3223)* and *Introduction to Political Data (PSC 2013)*.
- Designed and prepared course materials, including syllabi, lecture slides, and assignments.
- Provided instruction to 30 students in PSC 3223 and 20 students in PSC 2013.
- Managed all administrative aspects of courses, including communication with students and maintaining records.

Methods Tutor

Aug. 2025 – Dec. 2025

University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science

Supervisor(s): Taylor Delaney; Alisa Fryar

- Provided tutoring for graduate level methods courses *Introduction* and *Intermediate Analysis to Political and Administrative Data (P SC 5923 P SC 5933)*.

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Jan. 2025 – May 2025

University of Oklahoma, Price College of Business

Supervisor(s): Shad Satterthwaite; Jeremy Leader; Jason Kessler

- Assisted with management of *The Future of Space* and *Space and Small Business* courses in the Price College of Business Executive MBA program and Commercial Aerospace Applications certification.
- Managed grades, Canvas pages, syllabus structure, and assisted with technical aspects of course.

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Aug. 2020 – May 2022

University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science

Supervisor(s): Kathleen Tipler; Melody Rowlett

- Taught, managed, and curated lesson plans for lab sections of *Intro to American Politics and Democracy*.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Assistant

Aug. 2020 – Jun. 2023

U.S. Department of State - Greening Diplomacy Initiative, VSFS

Supervisor: Stephanie Christel

- Assisted in coordinating air quality program operations through the Greening Diplomacy Initiative between the Department of State, EPA, NASA, and US Forest Service.
- Organized air quality data, embassy, post, and consulate POC information, and MOUs.
- Created reports to assist in the correction of air quality monitors to efficiently collect data, publish blog posts, and assist in discrete projects.

Census Field Supervisor

Jan. 2020 – Jul. 2020

U.S. Census Bureau, Level: GS 04; Clearance: Confidential

Supervisor: Starr Wright

- Trained and supervised Enumerators and Census Field Supervisor Assistants to complete operations.
- Evaluated performance and recommended changes to data collection methods to Field Manager and office staff.
- Created assignments in the Operational Control System, reviewed/certified Enumerator's time and expense records, and resolved personnel conduct and performance problems.

Address Analyst and Canvasser

Aug. 2019 – Jan. 2020

U.S. Census Bureau, Level: GS 03

Supervisor: Audrey Duncan

- Used a satellite interface system (LiMA) to update and register housing in the US Census database.
- Communicated with members of the public on the upcoming Census and the importance of its completion.
- Updated data systems to demonstrate living quarters that were built, destroyed, altered, or moved.
- Upheld data stewardship of personally identifiable information and business identifiable information.

PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

Let there be light? Partisanship differences in light pollution mitigation strategies – **Cheyenne Black**, Andrew Fox, Maggie Leon-Corwin, Hank Jenkins-Smith, Carol Silva

Public attitudes and perspectives on the tradeoffs associated with limiting nighttime lighting – Andrew Fox, Maggie Leon-Corwin, Hank Jenkins-Smith, Carol Silva, **Cheyenne Black**, Jeffrey Kelly, Kyle Horton, Carolyn Burt, Ali Khalighifar, Grace Trankina

TECHNICAL REPORTS

The RAND Corporation - *Evolution or revolution? Modernizing legacy space systems of systems* - Eder Sousa, Bonnie Triezenberg, **Cheyenne Black**, Julia Coff, Arianne Collopy, Tyler Hoard, Thomas Light Dominique Lumpkin, Lauren Mayer, Mack Rodgers, Terry Wen - Project AIR FORCE Report

Department of State – *Addis Ababa Air Quality Monitor Installation* – DipNote

Department of State – *NASA & the MAIA Project* - DipNote

Institute for Public Policy Research and Analysis - *Public Preferences for U.S. Response Options to Potential Russian Use of Nuclear Weapons in Ukraine* - White Paper

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Analytical Article *The Conversation*

US participation in space has benefits at home and abroad: reaping them all will require collaboration

CERTIFICATIONS AND SUPPLEMENTAL EDUCATION

Department of Commerce Sensitive Data Stewardship Certification, ICPSR Maximum Likelihood Estimation: Generalized Models, ICPSR Mathematics for Social Scientists II, ICPSR Regression Analysis II: Linear Models, IQMR Computational Text Analysis, IQMR Network Analysis, IQMR Bayesian Statistics, IQMR Comparative Historical Analysis, RAND Forecasting Initiative (RFI) Training

PROGRAMMING/SOFTWARE SKILLS

R, Python, STATA, ArcGIS, Qualtrics, LiMA, L^AT_EX, NVivo, Discourse Network Analyzer (DNA), APIs, Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing (NLP)

CONFERENCES, PRESENTATIONS & SEMINARS

Presenter₁ Discussant₂ Chair₃ Round Table Participant₄ Guest Lecture₅

University of Colorado Denver - Center for Policy and Democracy₁ 2026

Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management₁ — American Political Science Association₁ — RAND Summer Associate Seminar Series₁ — International Conference on Public Policy_{1,2,3} — Bird Collision Prevention Alliance₁ — Oklahoma Aerospace and Defense Innovation Institute Defense Symposium 2025

German Political Science Association Academic Convention₄ — Institute of Comparative Politics and Public Policy₁ — Conference on Policy Process Research_{1,3} — Institute for Public Policy Research and Analysis₁ — Midwestern Political Science Association Annual Conference₁ — Southern Political Science Association Annual Conference₁ 2024

U.S. Department of State VSFS Project Presentation₁ — OU Making Public Policy₅ — OU Introduction to American Politics and Democracy₅ 2023

Oklahoma Aerospace and Defense Innovation Institute Defense Symposium₁ — OU Introduction to American Politics and Democracy₅ 2022

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee:

European Policy Analysis; Quality and Quantity; Review of Policy Research

Ask a Mountaineer program Sept. 2020 – Current
Appalachian State University - Alumni Network

Vice President Sep. 2022 – Sep. 2023
Graduate Association in Political Science, University of Oklahoma

Senator Oct. 2020 – Oct. 2021
Graduate Student Senate, University of Oklahoma

HONORS AND AWARDS

Frances E. and A. Earl Ziegler Sooner Heritage Scholarship, The University of Oklahoma 2025

John Halvor Leek Memorial Award, The University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science 2025

Robert E. and Mary B. Sturgis Endowed Scholarship, The University of Oklahoma 2025

Sarkeys Foundation Sooner Heritage Scholarship, The University of Oklahoma 2025

David R. Morgan Award, The University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science 2024

IQMR Funding Award, The University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science 2024

Robberson and Wethington Scholarship, The University of Oklahoma, Graduate College 2024

Frances E. and A. Earl Ziegler Sooner Heritage Scholarship, The University of Oklahoma 2024

John Halvor Leek Memorial Award, The University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science 2023

Sooner Heritage Scholarship, The University of Oklahoma 2023

Best ADQUANT Research Title, The University of Oklahoma, Department of Sociology 2021

H.V Thornton Memorial Award, The University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science 2021

Research Funding Award, The University of Oklahoma, Department of Political Science 2021

PAST AND PRESENT AFFILIATIONS

American Political Science Association
Association for Public Policy and Management
European Consortium for Political Research
German Political Science Association
Midwestern Political Science Association
Southern Political Science Association
Women Also Know Stuff